

Assignment 4 - Final Year Project I – Project Report (Interim Report)

Due: Before 23:59 on Tuesday 16 December 2025 in Week 16 (**this is a hard deadline**)

Weight: 30%

Length: 15 - 20 pages (excluding references and appendix)

Formatting:

- Times New Roman, 12 pt
- Single line spacing
- A4
- Margins: 2 cm (top, bottom, left, right)
- APA style citations
- Page numbers centred at the bottom
- Structure headings numbered consistently with the Table of Contents

1. Overview of Assignment 4

This Interim Project Report is a partial version of the full Final Year Project Report submitted at the end of FYP II. Because the project is still ongoing, some sections from the full report requirements are **not** expected in this assignment.

Students must demonstrate:

- Clear understanding of the project topic
- Background knowledge through literature review
- A well-structured methodology plan
- Early-stage progress
- Appropriate research planning and management
- Awareness of sustainability and ethical considerations
- Realistic future directions for next semester

This assignment evaluates your ability to prepare, plan, organize, and academically present your project based on what you have completed **so far**.

2. Required Sections for Assignment 4

Only sections that students can fully complete during FYP I are included. These correspond to the official UCA structure where applicable.

2.1 Cover Page

Should follow UCA guidelines:

- Project title (in ALL CAPS, starting 3.5 cm from the top)
- Student name, ID, contact information
- Supervisor name
- Date of submission

2.2 Abstract (up to 250 words)

A concise summary of:

- The problem or topic
- Why it is important
- Planned methods
- Expected outcomes

Because results are not yet produced, you may describe *anticipated* contributions.

2.3 Acknowledgements (optional)

(Optional but recommended)

Acknowledge those who supported you academically, technically, or personally.

2.4 Table of Contents

Should include all headings and subheadings, numbered identically to the text.

2.5 List of Abbreviations / Figures / Tables (if applicable)

Include only if your report contains these elements.

2.6 Statement of Authorship

A formal declaration that:

- The work is your own
- You followed UCA research ethics
- All sources used are referenced

3. Main Content (Required for FYP I)

These are taken from the full report structure but adapted for “interim status.”

1 Introduction

A strong introduction must:

- Introduce the project topic
- Explain academic relevance, societal importance, or practical significance
- Clearly state the research question(s) or project aim(s)
- Explain what problem your project solves and why it matters
- Provide a brief overview of how you intend to approach the problem

This section should show that you have deeply understood the context of your project.

2 Literature Review / Conceptual Framework

Summarize and synthesise relevant academic sources:

- What does existing research say about your topic?
- What theories, models, or frameworks inform your project?
- What gaps exist that your FYP aims to address?

Expected minimum: **15 - 20 academic sources** (journal articles, books, reputable conferences)

3 Methodology (Planned Methodology for FYP II)

Even if you have not executed the full study yet, you must describe:

- Type of research (experimental, qualitative, quantitative, design project, system implementation)
- Planned methods for data collection or system development
- Tools, materials, frameworks, or datasets you expect to use
- How you will analyse the data or evaluate the system
- Rationale: **Why these methods? Why not others?**

This section demonstrates preparedness and technical clarity.

4 Initial Progress / Preliminary Results (FYP I Only)

Include any early-stage results or progress:

- Prototype screenshots
- System architecture drafts
- Early experiments
- Preliminary datasets
- Early findings from observations or pilot tests
- Technical milestones achieved so far

Even if incomplete, describing preliminary progress is essential.

5 Project Management and Timeline

Provide:

- Gantt chart or timeline
- Milestones completed in FYP I
- Planned milestones for FYP II
- Risk management plan
- Supervisor consultation schedule

- Work division (if it is a group project)

This corresponds to the “process” expectations in the guidelines.

6 Sustainability Considerations

Discuss how your project contributes to one or more aspects of sustainability:

- Environmental sustainability
- Social sustainability
- Economic sustainability
- Ethical and responsible computing

This aligns with UCA’s emphasis on societal relevance.

7 Ethical and Research Integrity Considerations

Briefly address:

- Ethical issues in your research
- Privacy, data protection
- Human subjects (if applicable)
- Bias and fairness issues
- Compliance with UCA research ethics guidelines

8 Future Work (FYP II Plan)

Clearly outline next semester’s work:

- What tasks remain
- What data collection or implementation will be done
- Planned evaluation or analysis
- Anticipated challenges
- Expected final outcomes

This showcases foresight and structured planning.

4. References

APA format, alphabetical order.

All citations used in the text must appear here.

5. Appendix (Optional)

Include if relevant:

- Raw data
- System diagrams
- Survey instruments
- Prototype screenshots
- Codes used in early stages

Assessment Criteria (Adapted for FYP I)

Based on the official UCA assessment criteria for the full report, but adjusted for this interim version:

You will be assessed on:

1. **Clarity and strength of research question / project aim**
2. **Depth of literature review and understanding of related work**
3. **Appropriateness and clarity of proposed methodology**
4. **Quality of early progress / preliminary results**
5. **Quality of project planning and management**
6. **Integration of sustainability and ethics**
7. **Structure, academic writing, and formatting compliance**
8. **Use of credible academic sources**
9. **Professional presentation of the report**

Marking Rubric

Criteria	Excellent (90–100)	Very Good (75–90)	Good (60–75)	Fair (50–60)	Limited (0–50)
1. Introduction & Problem Definition 15 marks	Clear, compelling introduction; strong justification of problem; research question highly relevant and precise.	Clear introduction; good justification; research question relevant and mostly clear.	Adequate introduction; problem is understandable; research question is acceptable.	Weak introduction; unclear justification; poorly defined question.	Very unclear or missing introduction; no clear research question.
2. Literature Review & Background 20 marks	Thorough review; strong synthesis of sources; demonstrates deep understanding; clear conceptual framing.	Good review; good use of sources; conceptual framing mostly clear.	Adequate review; sources used but limited synthesis; conceptual framework basic.	Weak review; limited sources; little synthesis; unclear framework.	Very weak or missing review; sources absent or irrelevant.
3. Methodology & Project Design 20 marks	Methodology well-justified; clearly described; replicable; aligns perfectly with research question.	Strong methodology; mostly clear and justified; minor gaps.	Acceptable methodology; some justification missing; partially replicable.	Weak methodology; unclear steps; poor alignment to research question.	Very poor or missing methodology; no justification.
4. Progress, Work Completed & Findings So Far 20 marks	Extensive progress; work clearly documented; early findings or prototypes well presented.	Good progress; documentation clear; preliminary findings presented.	Adequate progress; some documentation; preliminary findings basic.	Limited progress; documentation unclear; weak or no early findings.	Very little or no progress; undocumented or unclear work.
5. Project Management, Planning & Sustainability 15 marks	Clear timeline; strong planning; realistic milestones; sustainability considerations integrated.	Good planning; milestones mostly realistic; some sustainability considered.	Acceptable planning; timeline exists but basic; limited sustainability mention.	Weak planning; unrealistic milestones; sustainability poorly addressed.	No planning; no timeline; sustainability missing.
6. Structure, Formatting & Academic Writing 10 marks	Excellent structure; logical flow; meets formatting requirements; strong academic language; error-free.	Very good structure; minor errors; formatting followed closely.	Good structure; some inconsistencies; few language errors.	Poor structure; weak flow; many errors; formatting inconsistent.	Very poor writing; unreadable; formatting ignored.
100 marks					